

Standard ECMA-55

Minimal BASIC

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Brief History

The first version of the language BASIC, acronym for Beginner's All-purpose Symbolic Instruction Code, was produced in 1964 at the Dartmouth College in the USA. This version of the language was oriented towards interactive use. Subsequently, a number of implementations of the language were prepared, that differed in part from the original one.

In 1974, the ECMA General assembly recognised the need for a standardised version of the language, and in September 1974 the first meeting of the ECMA Committee TC 21, BASIC, took place. In January 1974, a corresponding committee, X3J2, had been founded in the USA.

Through a strict co-operation it was possible to maintain full compatibility between the ANSI and the ECMA draft standards. The ANSI one was distributed for public comments in January 1976, and a number of comments were presented by ECMA.

A final version of the ECMA Standard was prepared at the meeting of June 1977 and adopted by the General Assembly of ECMA on Dec. 14, 1977 as Standard ECMA-55.

Scope

This Standard ECMA-55 is designed to promote the interchangeability of BASIC programs among a variety of automatic data processing systems. Subsequent Standards for the same purpose will describe extensions and enhancements to this Standard. Programs conforming to this Standard, as opposed to extensions or enhancements of this Standard, will be said to be written in “Minimal BASIC”.

This standard establishes:

- the syntax of a program written in Minimal BASIC.
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